



Learning Space

IAS MAINS 2020

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

CASE STUDIES

MODULE - 13

CASE STUDY - 13

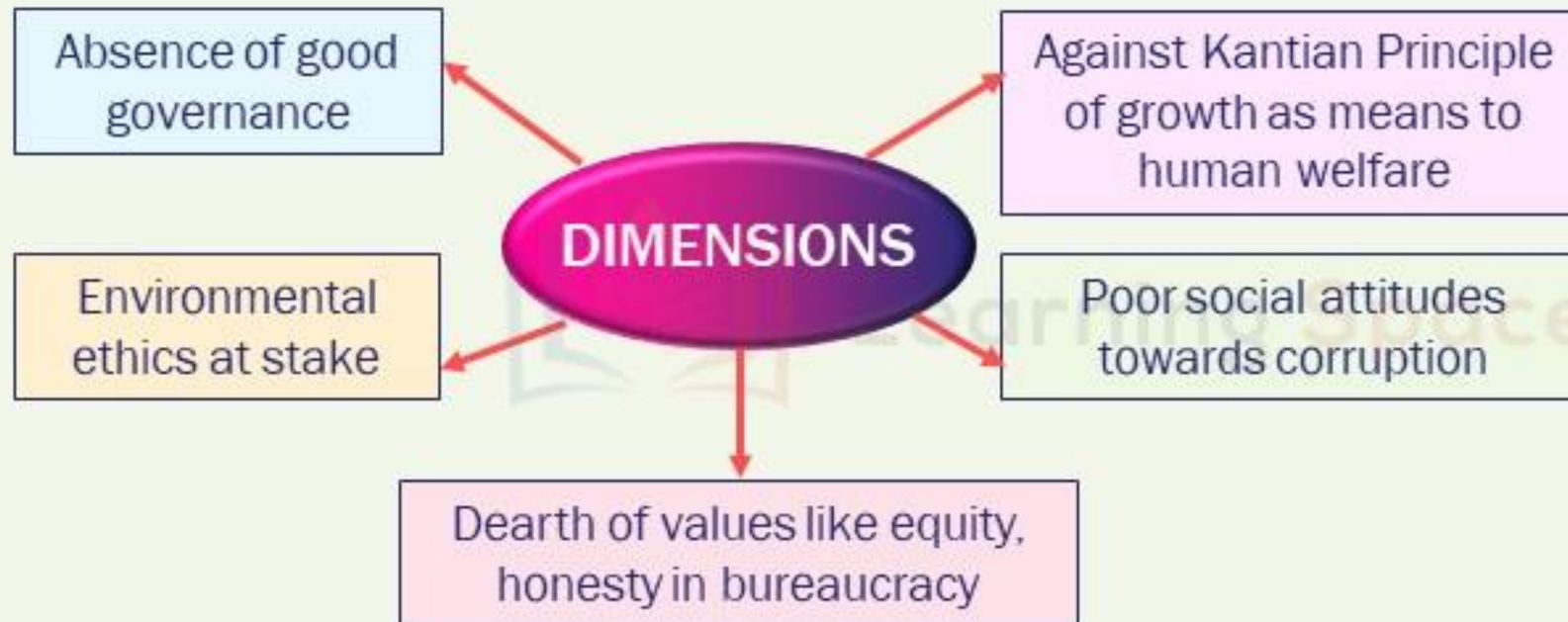
As a resident of a metropolitan city clogged with traffic and lack of affordable housing, you witnessed initiatives from the city administration to construct several flyover bridges to ease the traffic and rampant construction of apartments by private builders. There were several allegations of corruption in the dealings, with the opacity in the award of the contracts lending credence to the allegations. Lack of regular inspections and flouting of the norms during the construction went unreported. Street hawkers moved in quickly to use the space under the bridges for hawking, and the homeless to take shelter. On an unfortunate morning, during peak traffic hour, one of the newly constructed bridge collapsed, causing extensive damage to both human life and property.

What are the ethical dimensions of such rampant unregulated constructions. Explain the reasons for such incidents and measures needed to prevent their recurrence. (250 words)

CASE STUDIES

The case reflects the disastrous events like bridge collapse in Kolkata, apartment collapse in Mumbai etc. leading to stampede and loss of life.

ETHICAL DIMENSION



REASONS FOR SUCH INCIDENTS

- No long term plans for any city
- Government tendency to regularize illegal structure
- Unholy nexus between builders, mafia, local politicians and bureaucracy
- Lack of awareness among home buyers regarding illegal construction
- Absence of labor laws, especially in unorganized sector
- Contractors employing children and women as laborers at low wages
- No insurance and social security for workers
- Tendency of adhoc monetary compensation to victims whenever accidents occur
- Absence of regular inspections
- Distress migration being not prioritized in policy making
- Political populism incentivizing irregular constructions augmenting real estate mafia

MEASURES NEEDED

- Immediate stop to regularizing illegal structures
- Notify clear building Bylaws and create awareness regarding the same
- Complete transparency in giving permissions to builders
- Enabling e-governance to reduce personal interactions between builders and bureaucracy
- Mandating regular inspections
- Awareness campaigns by local administration among home buyers
- Labor reform should be implemented
- Strict implementation of child labor laws
- Criminal action against builders responsible for accidents
- Action against bureaucrats for no proper inspection

THE WAY AHEAD

Following the Kerala model of demolishing illegal structures in Maradu municipality, states should be proactive in early detection and prevention of such incidents.

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SINCERE THANKS
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